Dear Halden Pay Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform role. With nine years of experience designing, building and operating production data platforms and cloud warehouses, I have focused on creating reliable, reusable systems that make trusted data accessible to analytics and product teams. Halden Pay's emphasis on a shared platform and reusable frameworks is a strong match for my work building reusable ingestion, transformation, data-quality, and platform tooling.

In my current role, I own ingestion and orchestration across a production platform with around 140 Airflow DAGs and Snowflake. I migrated warehouse transformations to more than 420 tested dbt models and introduced incremental models and slim CI, reducing nightly build time from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. This included optimising large-scale warehouse workloads through incremental models and state:modified CI. I have also defined and enforced JSON Schema data contracts with CI checks, helping establish repeatable data-quality standards between product and data teams, reducing broken-pipeline incidents, and built a Kafka shipment-event pipeline processing around 30 million events a day. These projects reflect my hands-on experience with Python, SQL, data modelling, CI/CD and operating data systems at scale. I also designed a Redshift warehouse using a dimensional star schema with more than 30 fact and dimension tables for finance and risk teams.

My cloud experience includes AWS, including EMR, S3 and Glue, alongside Snowflake and Redshift. I have also contributed two merged pull requests to an open-source Airflow provider, fixing a pagination bug and adding tests. Across these experiences, I have aimed to improve reliability and simplify platform work, while mentoring colleagues and working across teams—an approach that aligns with Halden Pay's values of Ownership, Together and Pace.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my data-platform experience could contribute to Halden Pay's Data Platform team. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Lena Varga-Holm